StoryCast: Research and Planning

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GitHub: https://github.com/nirere123/storycast

Figma: https://www.figma.com/design/nE6KJ6mURLlW4a2NmgE9bu/storycast--website--mockups?node-id=0-1&p=f&t=F8ilEXS0KWLgQPJ7-0

Project Overview

StoryCast is a three-page website sharing audio and video stories about young entrepreneurs, their challenges, first customers, and lessons learned. Captions and transcripts make stories accessible to people.

Target Users

Young people are interested in entrepreneurship, including users who rely on screen readers, keyboards, or written content instead of audio.

Website Pages

- **Home (index.html):** Introduces StoryCast and features stories.
- **Story (story/amina.html):** Presents a story with video, audio, captions, transcript, and related stories.
- **About / Access (about.html):** Explains the mission, accessibility features and contact information. All pages share the navigation menu. The sitemap is available in storycast-sitemap.pdf.

Design

I planned the website using Figma wireframes and high-fidelity mockups for desktop (1440px) and mobile (390px). The cream background, green text, and lime highlights create a warm, readable design. Headings use Georgia, and body text uses Arial.

Technologies

HTML, Sass, and CSS without frameworks. Sass variables organize colors, typography, and spacing. CSS Grid handles page layouts. Flexbox handles navigation and buttons and responsive breakpoints at 850px and 560px plus a container query to adapt the design. The site uses semantic HTML elements and video captions.

Accessibility

I aim to follow WCAG 2.1 AA guidelines by providing captions, transcripts, sufficient color contrast, keyboard navigation, visible focus outlines, a skip link, meaningful image descriptions, proper heading order and reduced-motion support.

Content Note

The story is fictional. Created for this class project. Real stories will only be used with the person's

permission.

Testing Plan

I will test keyboard navigation, screen-reader support, HTML validity, Lighthouse accessibility, and layouts at 390px, 768px, and 1440px and caption accuracy.

Sources

- W3C WCAG 2.1: https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/
- W3C: Accessible Video: https://www.w3.org/WAI/media/av/
- MDN: The track element: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTML/Element/track
- MDN: CSS Container Queries: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/CSS_containment/Container_queries
- WebAIM Contrast Checker: https://webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker/
- Sass Documentation: https://sass-lang.com/documentation/

Information Architecture

StoryCast is organized into three main pages connected through a shared navigation menu.

- **Home:** Introduces StoryCast and displays featured entrepreneur stories.
- **Story Detail:** Presents an individual entrepreneur's story with audio, video, captions, a transcript, and related stories.
- **About / Access:** Explains the project's mission, accessibility features, and contact information.

Users can start on the Home page, open a featured story, and visit the About / Access page through the navigation menu. The sitemap illustrates this structure.

Design Rationale

The cream background provides a warm visual appearance, while dark green text helps keep the content readable. Lime highlights draw attention to important elements, such as buttons and calls to action. Georgia headings create a distinct style, while Arial body text keeps paragraphs simple and familiar.

The responsive layouts help the website adapt to desktop and mobile screens. Captions and transcripts allow users to access story content without relying only on audio.

Research Findings

The W3C Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) provide guidance for making web content accessible. W3C media accessibility resources explain the importance of making audio and video content available to users with different needs. MDN documentation supports the use of the HTML track element for video captions and CSS container queries for adapting components to their available space. These resources informed the project's plans for captions, transcripts, responsive layouts, and accessibility.

Technical Structure

The website uses semantic HTML to organize content, Sass to manage reusable styles, and compiled CSS to apply those styles in the browser. Sass variables and partials organize colors, typography, and spacing. CSS Grid manages larger page layouts, while Flexbox arranges navigation and smaller groups of elements. Media queries and a container query help the design adapt to different screen sizes and component widths.

Testing Results

The website will be evaluated at 390px, 768px, and 1440px screen widths. Testing will include keyboard navigation, visible focus indicators, captions and transcripts, HTML validity, and accessibility checks using Lighthouse.

Results: To be completed after testing. Record any issues found and the changes made to address them.